

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250283997

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

Koelsch; Andreas et al.

Method for Operating a Measuring Device

Abstract

A computer-implemented method for operating a measuring device, in particular a wall diagnostic device, includes receiving radar data of a radar sensor unit of the measuring device, the radar data depicting a wall to be diagnosed, and performing wall diagnostics by performing an analysis of the radar data and providing diagnostic results with a diagnostic module of the measuring device. The wall diagnostics includes performing an object recognition of an object disposed in the wall using the diagnostic module, the object recognition including object detection and object classification. The wall diagnostics further includes providing the diagnostic results from the diagnostic module to a display unit of the measuring device for displaying the diagnostic results to a user of the measuring device, wherein the diagnostic results include at least one object position in the wall and an object type of the object.

Inventors: Koelsch; Andreas (Peiting, DE), Frischen; Andreas (Leonberg, DE), Giliard; Anke (Stuttgart, DE), Moster; Benjamin (Niefern-Oeschelbronn, DE), Sgarz; Heiko (Leonberg, DE), Steuler; Jan Linus (Woelfersheim, DE), Messner; Jonas (Stuttgart, DE), Winterhalter; Juergen (Stuttgart, DE), Law; Kakit (Reutlingen, DE), Fiederer; Lukas (Balingen, DE), Brand; Michael (Berlin, DE), Vittal; Sachin Lingadahalli (Viernheim, DE), Krane; Stephan (Woerth Am Rhein, DE), Troeltzsch; Uwe (Roesrath, DE)

Applicant: Robert Bosch GmbH (Stuttgart, DE)

Family ID: 94772208

Appl. No.: 19/071230

Filed: March 05, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

DE

10 2024 202 238.1

Mar. 11, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G01S13/88 (20060101); G01S7/41 (20060101); G01S13/86 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G01S13/888 (20130101); G01S7/412 (20130101); G01S13/86 (20130101);

Background/Summary

[0001] This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 to application no. DE 10 2024 202 238.1, filed on Mar. 11, 2024 in Germany, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a method for operating a measuring device, in particular a wall diagnostic device.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Diagnostic devices for diagnosing walls and detecting objects formed in the walls are known in the prior art.

[0004] It is an object of the present disclosure to provide an improved method of operating a

[0005] measuring device, in particular a wall diagnostic device.

SUMMARY

[0006] According to one aspect, a computer-implemented method of operating a measuring device, in particular a wall diagnostic device is provided, comprising: [0007] receiving radar data from a radar sensor unit of the measuring device, wherein the radar data depicts a wall to be diagnosed; [0008] performing a wall diagnostics by performing an analysis of the radar data and providing diagnostic results via a diagnostic module of the measuring device, wherein the wall diagnostic comprises: [0009] performing an object recognition of an object disposed in the wall using the diagnostic module, wherein the object recognition comprises an object detection and an object classification; and [0010] providing the diagnostic results of the diagnostic module to a display unit of the measuring device for displaying the diagnostic results to a user of the measuring device, wherein the diagnostic results comprise at least one object position in the wall and an object type of the object.

[0011] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that an improved method for operating a measuring device, in particular a wall diagnostic device, can be provided. For this purpose, wall diagnostics are performed by a diagnostic module based on radar data from at least one radar sensor unit of the measuring device depicting a wall to be diagnosed. For this purpose, the wall diagnostics comprises an object recognition of at least one object disposed in the wall using the diagnostic module.

[0012] The object recognition comprises an object detection and object classification. Object detection comprises determining an object's position within the wall, and object classification comprises determining the type of object located in the wall. The diagnostic results of the wall diagnostics, including at least the object's position and type, are further displayed in a display unit of the measuring device. The correspondingly designed diagnostic module can perform the wall diagnostics, including the object recognition described above, based solely on radar data from the radar sensor unit.

[0013] By configuring the diagnostic module for the corresponding object recognition, including object detection and object classification, based solely on radar data, it is possible to avoid considering additional sensor information from additional sensors for the object recognition. As a

result, the measuring device can be designed more efficiently by eliminating the need for additional sensors besides the radar sensor unit.

[0014] According to one embodiment, the wall diagnostics further comprises:

[0015] performing a wall type classification and determining a wall type of the wall by the diagnostic module.

[0016] This can achieve the technical advantage that, in addition to object recognition, wall type classification can also be performed based solely on the radar data from the radar sensor unit. In the wall type classification, various wall types of the walls to be examined can be determined or classified by the correspondingly configured diagnostic module. Because the wall type is classified automatically, the user does not have to enter the respective wall type of the wall to be examined as additional information for the wall diagnostics, as is known from the prior art. Instead, the wall type is automatically determined by the diagnostic module based on the radar data from the radar sensor unit.

[0017] The wall type may be incorporated into the wall diagnostics and object recognition as additional information, for example for background correction. Alternatively or additionally, the detected wall type may be displayed to the user in the display unit as additional information in the diagnostic result.

[0018] According to one embodiment, the wall diagnostics further comprises: [0019] performing an object depth determination using the diagnostic module and determining an object depth of the object in the wall, wherein the object depth is defined as a distance of the object to a surface of the wall.

[0020] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that, based on the radar data of the radar sensor unit, an object depth of the object within the wall can be determined by the measuring device in addition to the object recognition. The object depth describes a distance of the object to a surface of the wall. The correspondingly configured diagnostic module may determine the object depth based solely on the radar data of the radar sensor unit.

[0021] According to one embodiment, the analysis of the radar data further comprises: [0022] performing an object extension determination and determining an object extension of the object along a predefined direction via the diagnostics module.

[0023] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that an object extension of the object detected in the wall is further enabled based on the radar data of the radar sensor unit. The object extension describes an extension of the object at least with respect to one spatial direction, preferably with respect to two spatial directions, especially preferably with respect to three spatial directions. This allows for a one-dimensional, preferably two-dimensional, more preferably three-dimensional extension information for the object located in the wall.

[0024] According to one embodiment, the wall diagnostics further comprises: [0025] performing a pre-processing of radar data of the radar sensor unit and providing input data to a wall type classification module of the diagnostic module using a first pre-processing module; [0026] performing the wall type classification based on the input data provided by the first pre-processing module and providing wall type information using a wall type classification module of the diagnostic module; [0027] performing a pre-processing of the radar data and providing input data to an object recognition module of the diagnostic module in consideration of the wall type information using a second pre-processing module of the diagnostic module; [0028] performing an object recognition based on the input data provided by the second pre-processing module and providing diagnostic results using the object recognition module.

[0029] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that precise wall diagnostics are enabled by the correspondingly configured diagnostic module using the radar data of the radar sensor unit.

[0030] By pre-processing the radar data of the radar sensor unit, the radar data can be brought into the form required for the wall diagnostics. Using a correspondingly configured wall type classification module, a corresponding wall type classification can be performed on the pre-

processed radar data and the respective wall type of the wall can be determined.

[0031] An object recognition of an object disposed in a wall may be performed by an object recognition module based on the pre-processed radar data and taking into account the wall type provided by the wall type classification module. The object recognition module is configured to perform an object detection and object classification of the object disposed in the wall based on the pre-processed radar data and taking into account the provided wall type. The presented architecture of the diagnostic module allows for the most precise and reliable wall diagnostics for walls to be examined.

[0032] According to one embodiment, radar data is received for a plurality of positions of the measuring device relative to the wall, wherein the method further comprises: [0033] receiving movement data of a movement detection unit of the measuring device, wherein the movement data represents a movement of the measuring device relative to the wall between the plurality of positions of the measuring device relative to the wall.

[0034] This can achieve the technical advantage that, by considering movement data from a movement detection unit, wall diagnostics can be performed for various positions of the measuring device relative to the wall. The movement data here depicts the movement of the measuring device between a plurality of positions of the measuring device relative to the wall. Considering the movement data thus allows for accurate positioning or position determination of the measuring device relative to the wall. Based on this, the wall diagnostics can be performed in a position-dependent manner for the various positions of the measuring device relative to the wall.

[0035] Furthermore, the movement of the measuring device between the various positions relative to the wall can be realized based on the movement data. This enables the wall diagnostics to be carried out while the measuring device is moving relative to the wall, enabling the wall diagnosis to examine a larger area of the wall than would be possible by the effective range of the radar sensor unit alone. This accelerates the wall diagnostics and allows for a more precise examination of a contiguous area of the wall to be examined.

[0036] According to one embodiment, the method furthermore comprises: [0037] checking, based on the movement data of the movement detection unit, whether a movement of the measuring device relative to the wall by a predefined distance has been detected; [0038] if no movement has been detected, storing the radar data and performing the check once again; [0039] If movement by the predefined distance has been detected, performing the wall diagnostics based on the radar data using the diagnostic module.

[0040] This can achieve the technical advantage that the wall diagnosis is performed at predetermined intervals while the measuring device is moving relative to the wall. The wall diagnostics are performed on the radar data captured by the measuring device during the movement relative to the wall over the predefined distance. The wall to be examined can thus be scanned by the measuring device within the wall diagnostics according to the predefined distance. This enables a precise wall diagnostics of an extended area of the wall to be examined.

[0041] According to one embodiment, the wall diagnostics further comprises: [0042] summarizing sub-objects detected and classified to a contiguous object based on radar data received at different positions of the measuring device relative to the wall, if there is a predefined distance dependency between the sub-objects.

[0043] In this way, the technical advantage can be achieved that by summarizing the sub-objects detected and classified relative to the wall in the various positions of the measuring device based on the radar data into a contiguous object, a precise wall diagnostics is possible, including a precise object recognition. While moving the measuring device relative to the wall, the wall diagnostics are performed according to the embodiments described above.

[0044] For the movement segments defined according to the predefined distances, the partial results, i.e. partial objects of the object to be detected within the wall, are determined by the diagnostic module during the wall diagnostics. The classified partial objects here describe portions

of an extended object that is depicted by movement of the measuring device relative to the wall in portions of the movement. By summarizing the correspondingly classified partial objects into an overall object, the extended object can be described and detected in detail. This allows for precise wall diagnostics and detection of extended objects.

[0045] According to one embodiment, the measuring device further comprises at least one of an induction sensor and/or an eddy current sensor and/or a capacitance sensor and/or an AC current sensor and/or a nuclear magnetic resonance (NMR) sensor and/or an ultrasonic sensor for providing additional sensor data, wherein the diagnostic module is configured to perform the wall diagnostics by taking into account the additional sensor data.

[0046] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that, through further sensor data, additional sensors, each of which is configured to detect different physical variables, can provide additional information in addition to the radar data of the radar sensor unit, for incorporation into the wall diagnostics. This additional information, which is preferably complementary to the information of the radar data of the radar sensor unit, allows further precise specification of the wall diagnostics or the object recognition.

[0047] According to one embodiment, the diagnostic module comprises at least one correspondingly trained artificial intelligence configured to perform an object recognition and/or wall classification and/or object depth determination based on the radar data and/or the additional sensor data.

[0048] The technical advantage can thereby be achieved that, because the diagnostic module is formed as a correspondingly trained artificial intelligence, that is trained based on the radar data, or, if applicable, taking into account the information of the additional sensors, to perform an object recognition and/or a wall classification and/or an object depth determination and/or an object extension determination, a reliable and powerful diagnostic module can be provided. By using the artificial intelligence technique, precise wall diagnostics can be provided.

[0049] Provided according to one aspect is a computing unit configured to perform the method of operating a measuring device according to one of the preceding embodiments.

[0050] Provided according to one aspect is a computer program product comprising instructions that, when the program is executed by a data processing unit, cause the data processing unit to perform the method for operating a measuring device according to one embodiment.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0051] Embodiments of the disclosure are described with reference to the following figures. The figures show:

[0052] FIG. 1 a schematic illustration of a measuring device according to one embodiment;

[0053] FIG. 2 a further schematic illustration of the measuring device according to a further embodiment;

[0054] FIG. 3 a further schematic illustration of the measuring device according to a further embodiment;

[0055] FIG. 4 a schematic illustration of a measurement of the measuring device according to one embodiment,

[0056] FIG. 5 a further schematic illustration of the measuring device according to a further embodiment;

[0057] FIG. 6 a flowchart of a method for operating a measuring device according to one embodiment,

[0058] FIG. 7 a further flowchart of the method for operating a measuring device according to a further embodiment,

[0059] FIG. 8 a further flowchart of the method for operating a measuring device according to a further embodiment, and

[0060] FIG. 9 a schematic representation of a computer program product.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0061] FIG. 1 shows a schematic representation of a measuring device **100** according to one embodiment.

[0062] The present disclosure relates to a measuring device, in particular to a wall diagnostic device for examining walls **105** to be processed. Wall diagnostic devices are known in the prior art that are used to detect objects disposed in walls. Such devices allow a user to examine walls to be processed to search for objects disposed in the walls in order to be able to perform planned work, for example drilling in walls, based on this such that damage to the objects disposed in the walls can be avoided.

[0063] In the embodiment shown, the measuring device **100** comprises a housing **150** having a handle **152** for grasping of the measuring device **100** by a user, a display unit **111** for displaying diagnostic results **109** of the wall diagnostics, and controls **154** for switching the measuring device **100** to various operating modes.

[0064] According to the disclosure, the measuring device **100** comprises at least one radar sensor unit **101**. By means of the radar sensor unit **101**, radar signals may be transmitted towards the wall **105** to be examined and radar signals reflected by the wall **105** may be received.

[0065] For example, the radar sensor unit **101** may be configured as a narrow band radar detector device in the 2.4 GHz to 2.4835 GHz frequency range or as an ultra-wide band radar detector device in the 1.8 GHz to 5.8 GHz frequency range.

[0066] The measuring device **100** further comprises a diagnostic module **107** executable on a computing unit **151** of the measuring device **100** to perform the wall diagnostics. The diagnostic module **107** is configured to perform a corresponding diagnosis of the wall to be examined based on the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101**. The radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** thereby depicts the wall **105** to be examined and, if applicable, objects **113** disposed within the wall **105**.

[0067] The wall diagnostics carried out by the diagnostic module **107** comprises at least performing an object recognition. The object recognition here comprises an object detection and an object classification of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105**. The object detection comprises at least the determination of an object position **115**. The object position here describes the positioning of the object disposed in the wall **105** with respect to a reference system defined by the measuring device **100**. The object classification of the detected object **113** comprises at least determining an object type **117** of the detected object **113**.

[0068] The diagnostic results of the wall diagnostics determined in this way, i.e. at least the determined object position **115** and/or the determined object type **117** of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105**, are subsequently presented in a display unit **111** of the measuring device **100** to a user of the measuring device **100**. For example, the display unit **111** may be configured as a corresponding display and the diagnostic results **109** may be visually displayed. Additionally, the display of the diagnostic results **109** may be supported via audible and/or haptic signals. For example, the haptic signals may be realized via corresponding vibration signals.

[0069] The object **113** can be shown in the display, for example, by means of a corresponding icon. The object **113** can be shown in the corresponding object position **115** in the display. The object extension **121** may be visualized by a corresponding size of the displayed icon. The particular object type **117** of the object **113** may be visualized with a corresponding term or color highlighting of the icon, or by a specific shape of the icon representing the object **113**.

[0070] Alternatively, the wall diagnostics may additionally comprise determining a wall type **123** in the form of a wall type classification of the wall **105** to be examined. The wall type **123** describes the respective type of the wall **105** to be examined. For example, the wall type may be associated

with corresponding wall type classes, which may comprise: Concrete wall, plasterboard/drywall wall, brick wall and/or wall bricks, underfloor heating, wall heating or similar wall types found in buildings.

[0071] According to one embodiment, the diagnostic module **107** is further configured to determine an object depth **119** of the object **113** within the wall **105** based on the radar data **103**. The object depth **119** is defined by a distance of the object formed in the wall **105** to a surface of the wall **105**. The distance may be defined on the object side, for example with respect to an object surface or with respect to an object center point. The distance to the surface of the wall **105** describes a shortest distance defined by a direction perpendicular to the surface of the wall **105**.

[0072] According to one embodiment, the diagnostic module **107** is further configured to determine an object extension **121** of the object **113** in at least one predefined direction based on the radar data **103**. The object extension **121** of the object **113** describes a spatial extension of the object **113** in at least one spatial direction, preferably in two spatial directions, particularly preferably in three spatial directions. The object **113** may be described here as a one-dimensional, two-dimensional, or three-dimensional object **113**.

[0073] In conventional use, the measuring device **100** is placed on the surface of the wall **105** to be examined. Radar signals are transmitted towards the wall **105** and radar signals reflected from the wall **105** or the objects **113** disposed there are received via the radar sensor unit **101**. This radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** is used by the diagnostic module **107** to perform the wall diagnostics described above and to determine corresponding diagnostic results **109**.

[0074] For example, the diagnostic results **109** may comprise the object position **115** and/or object type **117** of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105**. Alternatively or additionally, the diagnostic results **109** may comprise the wall type **123** of the wall **105** and/or the object depth **119** and/or the object extension **121** of the object **113**.

[0075] The diagnostic results **109** configured in this manner may subsequently be displayed to a user of the measuring device **100** in a display unit **111** of the measuring device **100**. The display unit **111** can be configured as a corresponding display, for example. The diagnostic results **109** may be displayed in graphical or textual form in the display unit **111**.

[0076] According to one embodiment, the measuring device **100** further comprises a motion detection unit **141**. The motion detection unit **141** may be used to detect movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**. The motion detection unit **141** may comprise, for example, at least one roller element for this purpose. When the roller element is placed on the wall surface of the wall **105**, movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** can be detected when the measuring device **100** moves along a direction of movement **153** by rolling the roller element. Alternatively, the motion detection unit **141** may have a different configuration by which a relative movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** can be detected.

[0077] By moving the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**, radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** may be captured for a plurality of different positions of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**. This allows a larger spatial area of the wall **105** to be examined than that given by the effective range of the radar sensor unit **101**. This allows for objects **113** to be captured that have a greater spatial extent than the effective range of the radar sensor unit **101**.

[0078] While the measuring device **100** moves along the direction of movement **153**, radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** may be captured continuously. The wall diagnostics may be evaluated by the diagnostic module **107** based on this radar data **103** while the measuring device **100** is moving along the direction of movement **153**. This allows for accelerated wall diagnostics, taking into account the positioning of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**.

[0079] According to its embodiment, the diagnostic module **107** is configured as a correspondingly trained artificial intelligence **125**. The artificial intelligence **125** is trained to perform the above-described wall diagnostics based on the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** and to determine at least the object position **115** and the object type **117** of an object **113** disposed in the

wall **105**. The object classification or determination the object type **117**, respectively, comprises assigning the detected object **113** to predefined object classes.

[0080] The object classes may comprise: Metal/non-metal object, low voltage cable, single phase AC signal cable, multi-phase AC signal cable, wood beam, metal beam, plastic pipe, water filled plastic pipe, for example fresh water pipe, non-water filled plastic pipe, for example waste water pipe, or other elements commonly installed in building walls.

[0081] Further, the artificial intelligence **125** may be trained to determine the wall type **123** of the wall **105** to be examined at least based on the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101**. Possible wall types **123** may comprise: Concrete wall, plasterboard/drywall wall, brick wall and/or individual bricks of the brick wall, underfloor heating, wall heating or other similar wall types commonly installed in buildings.

[0082] According to one embodiment, in addition to the radar sensor unit **101**, the measuring device **100** may comprise further additional sensors by means of which additional physical variables are detectable. For example, the measuring device **100** may comprise an induction sensor and/or an eddy current sensor and/or a capacitance sensor and/or an AC current sensor and/or an NMR sensor and/or an ultrasonic sensor or other sensors commonly used in wall diagnostic devices.

[0083] The diagnostic module **107**, in particular the corresponding trained artificial intelligence **125**, can be configured to perform wall diagnostics based on the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101** and taking into account the additional sensor information of the further sensors described above. The additional information of the additional sensors mentioned above can in particular be used for object recognition of the objects **113** disposed in the walls **105**. The additional sensor information may possibly provide improved detection of the objects **113** and may possibly provide improved classification of the objects **113**.

[0084] In particular, for example, the material of the objects **113**, for example as a metallic or non-metallic material, can be improved and classified by using the additional sensor information.

[0085] FIG. 2 shows another schematic representation of the measuring device **100** according to a further embodiment.

[0086] In the embodiment shown, the measuring device **100** comprises a pre-processing module **127** in addition to the diagnostic module **107**. For wall diagnostics, the measuring device **100** first receives the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101**. Pre-processing of the receiving radar data **103** is performed via the pre-processing module **127**. For example, via pre-processing of the pre-processing module **127**, the radar data may be brought into a corresponding data structure required for wall diagnostics by the diagnostic module **107**.

[0087] As described above, during wall diagnostics, the diagnostic module **107** generates the diagnostic results **109** described above. For example, the diagnostic results **109** may comprise the object position **115** and/or object type **117** and/or object depth **119** and/or object extension **121** of an object **113** formed in the wall to be examined **105** and/or the wall type **123** of the wall **105** to be examined. The correspondingly generated diagnostic results **109** may subsequently be displayed in the display unit **111** of the measuring device **100**.

[0088] According to one embodiment, in addition to the radar data **103** of the radar sensor unit **101**, the additional sensor information of the additional sensors described above may be included in the wall diagnostics of diagnostic module **107**. A corresponding pre-processing of the additional sensor information may be performed accordingly by the pre-processing module **127**.

[0089] In the embodiment shown, the diagnostic module **107** comprises a wall type classification module **129** and an object recognition module **131**. The pre-processing module **127** comprises a first pre-processing module **135** and a second pre-processing module **137**. The first pre-processing module **135** comprises an S matrix reduction **155**. The second pre-processing module **137** comprises a background correction **157**, an inverse Fast Fourier transformation **159**, and a focusing and migration **161**. In the pre-processing of the radar data **103** by the pre-processing module **127**,

the radar data **103** is first pre-processed by the first pre-processing module **135** and the S-matrix reduction **155** contained therein.

[0090] When doing so, the first pre-processing module **135** generates input data **133** based on the radar data **103**. The input data **133** serves as input data for the wall type classification module **129**. The wall type classification module **129** performs a wall type classification of the wall **105** to be examined based on the input data **133** and generates wall type information **139**. The wall type information **139** contains the wall type **123** of the wall **105** to be examined, as determined in the wall type classification.

[0091] Subsequently, the second pre-processing module **137** performs pre-processing based on the radar data **103** and the wall type information **139**. A background correction **157** of the radar data **103** is performed during this, taking into account the wall type **123** determined in the wall type information **139**. Depending on the wall type **123** of the wall **105** to be examined, different effects on the radar data **103** can occur.

[0092] These effects, which are primarily based on the respective wall type **123** and can affect object recognition, can be corrected by the background correction **157**. After the background correction has been performed, further pre-processing can be carried out by performing the inverse Fast Fourier transformation **159** or focusing and migration **161**, respectively, and input data **133** can be created for the object recognition module **131** once again. Based on the input data **133** provided by the second pre-processing module **137**, the object recognition module **131** performs the object recognition of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105** to be examined and determines at least the object position **115** and the object type **117** of the respective object **113**. Additionally, the object depth **119** and the object extension **121** may be determined by the object recognition module **131**.

[0093] According to one embodiment, the diagnostic module is further configured to determine an object depth of the object within the wall based on the radar data, wherein the object depth is defined by a distance of the object formed in the wall to a surface of the wall.

[0094] The pre-processing is optional. Depending on the algorithm used for the diagnostic module **107**, completely unprocessed radar echoes of different frequencies may be used as radar data **103** and as input data for the diagnostic module **107**. Alternatively, radar data **103** processed via multiple steps may be used. The pre-processing steps comprise, for example, the transformation of the signals from the frequency domain to the time or distance domain, background deduction, noise removal, and normalization of the signals. For radar data **103** which is available in the form of complex numbers, only the absolute value can be processed. Alternatively or additionally, the phase information may be considered.

[0095] FIG. **3** shows a further schematic representation of the measuring device **100** according to a further embodiment.

[0096] In the embodiment shown, the diagnostic module **107** comprises a plurality of parallel processing paths **102**. Each processing path **102** includes a pre-processing module **127**, the diagnostic module **107**, for example, comprising the wall type classification module **129** and/or the object recognition module **131** according to the embodiment in FIG. **2**, and a post-processing module **163**.

[0097] In FIG. **3**, primarily the radar data **103** is shown as input data for the wall diagnostics. In addition to the radar data shown, however, the additional information of the additional sensors may also serve as input data for the wall diagnostics. Here, the different information from the different types of sensors in the different parallel processing paths **102** can be processed and the corresponding wall diagnostics performed separately on the different sensor information. Upon completion of the wall diagnostics, a summary module may be used to assemble a summary of the individual sub-analysis results to form the diagnostic results **109** of the wall diagnostics.

[0098] Alternatively or additionally, different sub-aspects of the wall diagnostics may be performed by the different processing paths **102** based on the same sensor information.

[0099] For example, the individual processing paths **102** may process different radar data **103**

captured during movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** for different positions of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**. The radar data **103**, thus representing different regions of the wall **105** and captured sequentially in time as the measuring device **100** moved relative to the wall **105**, may then be processed in the different processing paths **102** by the modules shown.

[0100] The different processing paths perform a stand-alone wall diagnostics in this respect, comprising at least determining the object position **115** and/or the object type **117** of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105**.

[0101] The summary module **165** may summarize the sub-results provided in the individual processing paths **102** of the stand-alone wall diagnostics of the different regions of the wall **105** into a contiguous diagnostic result **109**. The contiguous diagnostic result here describes the wall diagnostics of a contiguous spatial area that was covered during movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** and depicted by the corresponding captured radar data **103**. The parallel processing of the radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** of the additional sensor elements in the different processing paths **102** thus enables accelerated wall diagnostics.

[0102] Alternatively, various wall diagnostic functions may also be performed in the different processing paths **102**. For example, in one processing path **102**, the wall type classification and the determination of the wall type **123** of the wall **105** to be examined can be performed. In another processing path **102**, object recognition of the object disposed in the wall **113** can be performed. The object detection can be performed with the determination of the object position **115** and the object classification can be performed with the determination of the object type **113** in one processing path **102**.

[0103] Alternatively, the object detection and object classification may then also be performed in two separate processing paths **102**. In further processing paths **102**, the object depth determination, i.e., the determination of the object depth **119** and/or the determination of the object extension **121** may respectively be carried out. In the summary module **165**, the various sub-results of the wall diagnostics may be summarized into corresponding diagnostic results **109**.

[0104] The diagnostic module **107** can be divided into different artificial intelligences **125**, as already shown in the embodiment in FIG. 2. For example, the diagnostic module **107** may comprise a wall type classification module **129** and an object recognition module **131**. The object recognition module may in turn be divided into an object detection module and an object classification module. The diagnostic module **107** may further comprise an object depth determination module and object extension module, respectively configured to determine the object depth **119** and the object extension **121**.

[0105] The respective modules may each be configured as stand-alone artificial intelligences **125**, for example, neural networks. Alternatively, the various modules may form portions of an overall artificial neural network that are connected to an overall neural network according to structures known in the prior art.

[0106] FIG. 4 shows a schematic illustration of a measurement of the measuring device **100** according to one embodiment.

[0107] For pre-processing, the radar data **103** or the additional sensor information **104** of the remaining sensors may be normalized, in particular to numerically stabilize the subsequent steps performed by the diagnostic module **107** during wall diagnostics. For example, an amplitude and/or offset compensation may be performed for this purpose. Further, to reduce interference, filtering of the radar data **103** may be carried out, and to reduce the data rate the corresponding sensor data may be sampled. Further, the radar data **103** or the additional sensor information **104** may be transformed to the respective required frequency range or time range. Methods known from the prior art can be used for this purpose.

[0108] Further, the captured radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** may be divided into temporal or spatial windows **167**. Temporal windows **167** may be generated by recording the

radar data **103** or the additional sensor information or the pre-processed radar data **103** over a fixed time interval. Spatial windows **167**, on the other hand, may be generated from a mapping of the radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** to positions of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** along the direction of movement **153**.

[0109] Graph a) of FIG. **4** shows such a data matrix resulting from the steps described above. The data matrix of the window **167** shown in graph a) shows a plurality of sensor data, which may comprise, for example, radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** of the further sensors plotted along a frequency channel axis **171** or along a space/time axis **169**, respectively.

[0110] A width of the temporal windows **167** may be selected such that different sampling rates of the sensors may be balanced and a new window **167** may be provided frequently enough so that a display of the diagnostic results **109** of the wall diagnostics in the display unit **111** may be shown without too great of a time delay while the measurement is being performed or shortly after the measurement of the measuring device **100** ends.

[0111] A rate of 2 to 20 windows per second of the data recording of the sensor data may be advantageous for this purpose. For spatial windows, the spatial sampling rates can be selected to achieve the desired local accuracy. Advantageously, 1 mm to 1 cm sampling rates can be used. This means that corresponding sensor data is captured every 1 mm to 1 cm of movement of the measuring device **100** along the direction of movement **153**.

[0112] A width of the spatial windows **167** may be selected such that contiguous information relating to an object **113** is contained in a window. Advantageously, a width of the respective spatial windows **167** can be 1 cm to 20 cm. This results in 4 to 100 measured values per window **167**. This allows for further efficient algorithmic processing of the correspondingly recorded radar data **103** or additional sensor information by the diagnostic module **107**.

[0113] A further temporal window **167** or spatial window **167** can be provided as soon as one or more scan points are available.

[0114] The diagnostic module **107** may be oriented such that a matrix corresponding to the window size of the respective spatial or temporal window **167** may be included as input data, for example of each processing path **102** of the embodiment in FIG. **3** as well. According to the embodiment of FIG. **2**, the corresponding input data can comprise the respective pre-processed sensor data, i.e. radar data **103** and additional sensor information **104** of the additional sensors.

[0115] As stated above, wall diagnostics may be performed by the diagnostic module **107** based on a correspondingly trained artificial intelligence. Alternatively, different processing paths may also be calculated by rule-based algorithms. A combination of artificial intelligence and a rule-based algorithm is also possible within a processing path **102** in the form of a parallel connection or concatenation.

[0116] The diagnostic results **109** of the wall diagnostics may be implemented as numeric values, vectors, or matrices. Further, the probability of detection, or for the wall type classification and/or the object classification, respectively, a probability of the specified object classes and/or wall type classifications can be given for the object detection. The same may apply to the position and/or depth determination, for which corresponding probability values can also be given.

[0117] If, in addition to the radar data **103**, the additional sensor information of the further sensor types is processed in a processing path **102**, these may either be merged within the artificial intelligence **125** or combined by rule-based combinations.

[0118] In the post-processing of each processing path **102**, of the embodiment of FIG. **3**, multiple algorithm results based on multiple windows **167** may be summarized by the summary module **165**. This summary can in particular be realized by majority formation, sum formation or also by multiplication of successive probability values.

[0119] Further, by clustering multiple results, for example, it is possible to detect which objects of multiple detected objects lying close to one another are the same object so that they are not incorrectly detected multiple times.

[0120] Likewise, it is possible to multiply a weighting function **177** when summarizing the results from multiple windows **167**. Advantageously, the diagnostic sub-results **175** corresponding to corresponding data points in the space may be weighted with respect to positioning of the diagnostic sub-results **175** relative to a center point of the respective window **167**. This is illustrated by way of example in graph b), in which the individual diagnostic sub-results **175** are weighted according to the weighting function **177** shown with respect to the center point of the window **167** shown.

[0121] According to one embodiment, the results of one processing path **102** after post-processing **163** may influence the extension of another processing path **102**. Here, weighting parameters may be adjusted that may depend on the particular result from the processing path **102** for each window.

[0122] For example, the result of an object classification in which the object type **117** of an object disposed in the wall **105** is defined can be utilized to increase the weight of a wall type classification in which the wall type **123** of the respective wall **105** is determined in the post-processing at locations without objects **113**, because the respective radar data **103** at these locations are less influenced by reflections of the objects **113**.

[0123] FIG. 5 shows a further schematic representation of the measuring device **100** according to a further embodiment.

[0124] Graphs a) and b) of FIG. 5 show two different alternatives of a joint data processing of radar data **103** and additional sensor information **104** by the diagnostic module **107**.

[0125] Graph b) illustrates a joint processing of the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104** of the additional sensors by the diagnostic module **107**. For this purpose, the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104** are collectively used as input data of the diagnostic module **107** configured as an artificial intelligence, in particular as an artificial neural network. The diagnostic module **107** here comprises multiple convolutions **108** and multiple dense layers **106**. The radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104** are processed jointly as input data via the convolutions **108** and dense layers **106**. The aforementioned diagnostic results **109** are created as output data of the diagnostic module **107**, based on this.

[0126] In graph b), in contrast, the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104** are used as stand-alone input data of the diagnostic module **107**. The diagnostic module **107** becomes multiple processing paths **102**. The processing paths **102** each comprise multiple convolutions **108** and at least one dense layer **106**. In the various processing paths **102**, wall diagnostics are performed separately by the diagnostic module **107** based on the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104**, respectively.

[0127] In an additional concatenation layer **148**, the partial results of the partial diagnoses of the different processing paths **102** are combined and fed to a final dense layer **106**. The output data of the diagnostic module **107** corresponds to the diagnostic results **109** described above.

[0128] The correspondingly configured diagnostic module **107** is designed to perform wall diagnostics as described above, including the features described above, based on the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104**.

[0129] In the embodiment shown, the diagnostic module **107** is configured as an artificial neural network, in particular as a convolutional network. Corresponding network architectures with convolutions **108**, dense layers **106**, and concatenation layers **148** are known from the prior art.

[0130] FIG. 6 shows a flowchart of a method **200** for operating a measuring device **100** according to one embodiment.

[0131] To operate the measuring device **100**, in a first method step **201**, radar data **103** of a radar sensor unit **101** of the measuring device **100** is first received. The radar data **103** here depicts a wall **105** to be diagnosed. Additionally, additional sensor information **104** may be received from additional sensors of the measuring device **100**.

[0132] In a subsequent method step **203**, the wall diagnostics are performed by the diagnostic module **107** of the measuring device **100** based on the radar data **103** and the additional sensor data

104. The diagnostic module **107** analyzes the radar data **103** and additional sensor information **104**, and provides corresponding diagnostic results **109**.

[0133] For this purpose, in a further method step **205**, the diagnostic module **107** performs an object recognition of an object located in the wall **105**. The object recognition comprises an object detection, in which an object position **115** of the object **113** is determined in the wall **105**, and an object classification, in which an object type **117** of the object **113** is determined.

[0134] In a further method step **207**, the diagnostic results **109** of the wall diagnostics are displayed in a display unit **111** of the measuring device **100**. The diagnostic results **109** comprise at least the object position **115** in the wall **105** and the object type **117** of the object **113**.

[0135] FIG. **7** shows a further flowchart of the method **200** for operating a measuring device **100** according to a further embodiment.

[0136] The embodiment shown is based on the embodiment of FIG. **6** and comprises all the features described therein.

[0137] In the embodiment shown, the method step **203** first comprises a method step **215**. In method step **215**, a first pre-processing module **135** pre-processes the radar data **103** or the additional sensor information **104**, respectively, and provides input data **133** to a wall type classification module **129**. For this purpose, the first pre-processing module **135** according to the embodiment in FIG. **2** may execute an S-matrix reduction **155**.

[0138] In a method step **209**, a wall type classification is performed by the wall type classification module **129** based on the input data **133** and a wall type **123** of the wall **105** being examined is determined.

[0139] Further, the wall type classification module **129** provides wall type information **139** comprising the previously determined wall type **123** of wall **105**.

[0140] In a further method step **217**, a second pre-processing module **137** performs pre-processing of the radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104**, taking into account the wall type information **139** provided by the wall type classification module **129**. For this purpose, according to the embodiment in FIG. **2**, the second pre-processing module may perform a background correction **157** of the radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104**, taking into account the wall type information **139**. In the background correction, the information on the wall type **123** of the wall is used to correct the radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104**, respectively.

[0141] Depending on the wall type **123** of the wall to be examined, deviations in the received radar data **103** or sensor information **104** may occur. These may be corrected in consideration of the present wall type **123** such that the corrected radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** provides wall-type independent information.

[0142] Further, an inverse Fast Fourier transformation **159** of the wall type corrected data may be performed by the second pre-processing module **137**. Additionally, focusing and migration **161** may be performed. Based on this, input data **133** is provided to an object detection module **131** by the second pre-processing module **137**.

[0143] In method step **205**, the object detection module **131** performs an object recognition of the object **113** disposed in the wall **105** based on the input data **133**, including object detection and object classification.

[0144] Further, in a method step **211**, an object depth determination of an object depth **119** of the object **113** may be performed in the wall **105**. This may in turn be determined by the correspondingly configured object recognition module **131**. The object depth describes a section of the object **113** towards a surface of the wall **105**.

[0145] Further, in a method step **213**, an object extension **121** of the object **113** may be determined along a predefined direction using the object detection module **131**.

[0146] FIG. **8** shows a further flowchart of the method **200** for operating a measuring device **100** according to a further embodiment.

[0147] The embodiment shown is based on the embodiments of FIG. **6**, **7** and comprises all the

features described therein.

[0148] In the embodiment shown, in a method step **219**, movement data of a motion detection unit **141** of the measuring device **100** is first received. The movement data here depicts a movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** between a plurality of positions of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**.

[0149] In a further method step **221**, based on the movement data of the movement detection unit **141**, a check is carried out to determine whether a movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** has been detected over a predefined distance.

[0150] If no such movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** has been detected, then in a method step **223**, the radar data **103** or the additional sensor information **104** stored in a time period between a previous check and the most recent check is stored. Further, the movement is checked once again.

[0151] If such movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105** has been detected over the predefined distance, the wall diagnostics are performed by the diagnostic module **107**, according to the embodiments described above, based on the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104**, respectively. The wall diagnostics are performed while the measuring device is moving **100** relative to the wall. Here, the wall diagnostics are divided into several successively performed sections, and partial results of the wall diagnostics are determined in the different sections. The partial results here describe partial objects that are detected during object recognition by the diagnostic module **107**.

[0152] For example, the sub-objects may include sub-sections of a contiguous object **113**, as the measuring device **100** performs the scan during its movement relative to the wall **105**. The sections of the contiguous object **113** represented by the sub-objects result from the predefined distances traveled by the measuring device **100** while it moves relative to the wall **105**.

[0153] In a further method step **225**, the sub-objects detected during the wall diagnostics are summarized into a contiguous object **113**. Summarizing or assembling the sub-objects into the contiguous object **113** occurs primarily if there is a predefined distance dependency between the sub-objects. The distance dependency describes that the sub-objects are respective parts of the contiguous object **113**.

[0154] The summarizing of the partial results may also refer to the separate processing in processing paths **102** according to the embodiments of FIGS. **3** and **5**, in which the radar data **103** and the additional sensor information **104** are processed separately in processing paths **102** configured independently from each other. The partial results produced in the processing paths **102** are subsequently summarized into the overall result.

[0155] Furthermore, the partial results may be related to the various aspects of wall diagnosis. Thus, the object position **115**, object type **117**, object depth **119**, and/or object extension **121**, as described in the embodiment of FIG. **3**, may be determined in different processing paths **102** as stand-alone sub-results. In the summary, the various sub-results may be merged into an overall result that a contiguous object **113** of a determined object type **117** and a determined object extension **121** is located at a determined object depth **119** at an object position **115** in the wall **105**.

[0156] As described above, the wall diagnostics can be performed by the measurement device **100** based on windows **167** of the radar data **103** and additional sensor information **104**. The windows **167** describe a spatial area of the wall **105** to be examined, which is recorded by the measurement device **100** in a specific position relative to the wall **105** by capturing radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104**. As the measurement device **100** moves relative to the wall, multiple windows **167** are captured in succession, which may overlap and which contiguously depict a spatial area of the wall **105** that was covered by the movement of the measurement device **100** relative to the wall **105**.

[0157] By combining the various windows **167**, the contiguous spatial area can be examined through wall diagnostics, and an object **113** located in the spatial area can be detected and classified

as a contiguous object. The merging of multiple windows **167** can occur, for example, through clustering at multiple measurement points. The measurement points describe positions of the measurement device **100** relative to the wall where radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** was recorded.

[0158] The windows **167** are then merged through clustering if the measurement points at which the respective windows **167** were captured are considered contiguous due to a predetermined geometric distance between the measurement points. This summarizing or merging can also be understood as grouping. An object **113** can be detected in each of the individual windows **167**, if such an object **113** is present. Alternatively, no such object **113** is detected in a window **167**. Upon detection of an object **113**, the object position **115**, the respective object type **117**, the object depth **119**, and/or the object extension **121** are subsequently determined.

[0159] An extended object **113** disposed in the wall **105** is traversed by movement of the measuring device **100** relative to the wall **105**, and corresponding data is collected. This allows the object **113** to be sampled from different viewing directions. As a result, data variance may be increased, and more robust object detection may be achieved.

[0160] According to one embodiment, the diagnostic module **107** is configured as a correspondingly trained artificial intelligence, which is designed to perform the above-described wall diagnostics. Training of the artificial intelligence can be carried out in accordance with training methods known from the prior art.

[0161] The training datasets used for the training may comprise radar data **103** and optionally additional sensor information **104**, each representing walls **105** of different wall types **123** with different objects **113** arranged in the walls **105** of different object types **117**. These objects are each positioned at different object positions **115** at different object depths **119** in the walls **105** and have different object extensions **121**.

[0162] The corresponding data of the training datasets are labeled by a characteristic labeling method, whereby the respective data is classified with respect to the respective wall type **123**, the presence of an object **113**, an object position **115**, an object type **117**, an object depth **119**, and/or an object extension **121**. For example, the respective radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** may be based on actual measurements of a corresponding measuring device **100** from real walls **105**.

[0163] For the purpose of generating training datasets, corresponding measuring devices **100** may be used to collect relevant datasets from real walls **105** with real objects **113** arranged in them. Alternatively or additionally, the data of the training datasets may include laboratory data that simulates, for example, only corresponding radar data **103** or additional sensor information **104** of walls **105** with objects **113**.

[0164] Alternatively or additionally, the data of the training data sets may be based on measurements from measuring devices **100** taken on pre-prepared laboratory walls, wherein the object positions **115** in the laboratory walls, object types **117**, object depths **119**, and/or object extensions **121** of the objects **113** disposed in the walls **105**, as well as the wall types **123** of the walls **105** are known.

[0165] The training of the artificial intelligence **125** may be configured to perform object recognition, including object detection and object classification of the objects **113**. The artificial intelligence **125** can be further trained to determine the wall type **123**. The artificial intelligence **125** can be further trained to determine the object depth **119**. The artificial intelligence can be further trained to determine the object extension **121**.

[0166] Alternatively, the diagnostic module **107** may comprise multiple artificial intelligences **125**, each trained to perform the object recognition, wall type classification, object depth determination, or object extension determination.

[0167] FIG. **9** shows a schematic representation of a computer program product **500** comprising instructions that, when the program is executed by a data processing unit, cause the latter to

perform the method **200** for operating a measuring device **100**.

[0168] In the embodiment shown, the computer program product **500** is stored on a storage medium **501**. The storage medium **501** can in this case be any desired storage medium known from the prior art.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method of operating a measuring device configured as a wall diagnostic device, comprising: receiving radar data of a radar sensor unit of the wall diagnostic device, the radar data depicting a wall to be diagnosed; performing wall diagnostics by performing an analysis of the radar data and providing diagnostic results with a diagnostic module of the measuring device, the wall diagnostics comprising: performing an object recognition of an object disposed in the wall using the diagnostic module, the object recognition including object detection and object classification; and providing the diagnostic results from the diagnostic module to a display unit of the measuring device for displaying the diagnostic results to a user of the measuring device, the diagnostic results including at least one object position in the wall and an object type of the object.
2. The method according to claim 1, the performing of the wall diagnostics further comprising: performing a wall type classification and determining a wall type of the wall using the diagnostic module.
3. The method according to claim 1, the performing of the wall diagnostics further comprising: performing an object depth determination and determining an object depth of the object in the wall using the diagnostic module, wherein the object depth is defined as a distance of the object to a surface of the wall.
4. The method according to claim 1, the analysis of the radar data further comprising: performing an object extension determination and determining an object extension of the object along a predefined direction using the diagnostic module.
5. The method according to claim 1, the performing of the wall diagnostics further comprising: performing a pre-processing of radar data of the radar sensor unit and providing input data to a wall type classification module of the diagnostic module using a first pre-processing module; performing the wall type classification based on the input data provided by the first pre-processing module and providing wall type information using a wall type classification module of the diagnostic module; performing pre-processing of the radar data and providing input data to an object recognition module of the diagnostic module, taking into account the wall type information using a second pre-processing module of the diagnostic module; and performing the object recognition based on the input data provided by the second pre-processing module and providing diagnostic results using the object detection module.
6. The method according to claim 1, wherein: the receiving of the radar data includes receiving the radar data from a plurality of positions of the measuring device relative to the wall, and the method further comprises receiving movement data of a movement detection unit of the measuring device, the movement data representing a movement of the measuring device relative to the wall between the plurality of positions of the measuring device relative to the wall.
7. The method according to claim 6, further comprising: checking, based on the movement data of the movement detection unit, whether a movement of the measuring device relative to the wall by a predefined distance has been detected; when the movement is not detected, storing the radar data and performing the check again; when the movement by the predefined distance is detected, performing the wall diagnostics based on the radar data using the diagnostic module.
8. The method according to claim 1, the performing of the wall diagnostics further comprising: summarizing sub-objects detected and classified at various positions of the measuring device relative to the wall, based on radar data to a contiguous object, when there is a predefined distance

dependency between the sub-objects.

9. The method according to claim 1, wherein: the measuring device further comprises at least one of an induction sensor, an eddy current sensor, a capacitance sensor, an AC current sensor, a nuclear magnetic resonance (NMR) sensor, and an ultrasonic sensor configured to provide additional sensor data, and the diagnostic module is configured to perform the wall diagnostics by taking into account the additional sensor data.

10. The method according to claim 1, wherein the diagnostic module comprises at least one correspondingly trained artificial intelligence configured to perform at least part of the wall diagnostics based on the radar data and/or additional sensor data.

11. A computing unit comprising: a computer program including instructions that, when executed by a data processing unit, cause the wall diagnostic device to perform the method of claim 1.

12. A computer program product comprising instructions which, when the program is executed by a data processing unit, cause the data processing unit to perform the method for operating the wall diagnostic device according to claim 1.
